

Riddhi Bandyopadhyay

Curriculum Vitae

Assistant Professor
Department of Physics and Astronomy, University of Delaware
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EDUCATION

- 2016- 2020 **Ph.D. in Physics**, University of Delaware, Newark DE, USA
Thesis supervisor: Prof. [William H. Matthaeus](#)
- 2014- 2016 **M.Sc. in Physics**, Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur, India
- 2011- 2014 **B.Sc. with Physics Honours**, University of Calcutta, India

PROFESSIONAL EMPLOYMENT

- 2025- present Assistant Professor (tenure track)
Department of Physics and Astronomy, **University of Delaware**, Newark DE, USA
- 2021- present Associate Research Scholar
Department of Astrophysical Sciences, **Princeton University**, Princeton NJ, USA
- 2020- 2021 Postdoctoral Research Associate
Department of Astrophysical Sciences, **Princeton University**, Princeton NJ, USA
Group of Prof. [David J. McComas](#).
- 2020- 2020 Postdoctoral Researcher
Department of Physics and Astronomy, **University of Delaware**, Newark DE, USA
Group of Prof. [William H. Matthaeus](#).

HONORS AND AWARDS

An article titled “Collisional-like dissipation in collisionless plasmas” was chosen as a Featured Article in [Physics of Plasmas](#). Companion science highlight published in [Scilight](#).

2021 [AAPPS-DPP U30 \(under 30 years old\) Doctoral Scientist/Student Award](#) instituted by the Division of Plasma Physics, Association of Asia-Pacific Physical Societies (AAPPS-DPP).

2020 [Parvez Guzdar Young Scientist Award](#) instituted by the Institute for Plasma Research, Bhat, Gandhinagar, India.

2020 Daicar-Bata Award, Department of Physics and Astronomy, University of Delaware, for authoring one of the department’s three most impactful publications.

2020 [Donald L. Turcotte Award](#) from American Geophysical Union (AGU) for outstanding dissertation research that contributes directly to nonlinear geophysics.

2020 Qaisar and Monika Shafi Theoretical Physics Outstanding Dissertation Award, Department of Physics and Astronomy, University of Delaware.

2019 Daicar-Bata Highest GPA Award, Department of Physics and Astronomy, University of Delaware.

Innovation in Science Pursuit for Inspired Research (INSPIRE) scholarship by Ministry of Science and Technology, Government of India for a period of five years (2011 – 2016).

RESEARCH GRANT SELECTION

NASA ROSES-2020 Heliophysics Guest Investigator (H-GI) “Open” Program: “Investigation of the Nature of Turbulent Dissipation in near-Earth Space Plasma” (**PI**, 2021 – 2025).

NASA ROSES-2021 Parker Solar Probe Guest Investigator (PSP-GI) Program: “Geometry of Magnetic Fluctuations near the Sun” (**PI**, 2021 – 2025).

NASA MMS Early-Career Grant: “Ion and Electron Heating within Current Sheets in the Magnetosheath” (**PI**, 2021 – 2025).

INVITED TALKS

Pathways to Dissipation in Weakly-Collisional Plasmas, Geophysical Fluid Dynamics Session, AGU 2020.

Dissipation in Electron-only Reconnection Events: Insights from Pressure-Strain Interaction, Electron-only Reconnection Splinter Session, MMS Spring 2021 SWT Meeting.

Characterization of the sub-Alfvénic Solar Wind Observed by Parker Solar Probe, Asia Oceania Geosciences Society (AOGS) 2022 Virtual Meeting.

Energy transfer and proton-electron heating in turbulent plasmas, TESS 2022.

Energy transfer and proton-electron heating in turbulent plasmas, AAPPs-DPP 2022.

Energy Dissipation in Electron-only Reconnection, MR2023 Workshop on Magnetic Reconnection.

Turbulent Cascade and Proton–Electron Heating in Collisionless Plasmas, AGU 2023.

Studies of Multi-Scale Processes in Space Plasmas, Colloquium at the Department of Physics, University of Texas at Dallas.

PUBLICATIONS (26 first author, [Google-Scholar](#) citations=2310, h-index=27)*

- [1] Joshua Goodwill, Subash Adhikari, Dominic Payne, **Riddhi Bandyopadhyay**, *et al.*, *Parker Solar Probe analysis across the Alfvénic transition: velocity shear, magnetic deflection, and switchback formation*. Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, **vol. 547**(2), (2026), p. stag242. ISSN 0035-8711. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1093/mnras/stag242>.
- [2] Shadia Rifai Habbal, Shaheda Begum Shaik, Zachary Bailey, Nathalia Alzate, *et al.*, *Tracking the Evolution of Plasma Instabilities from the Prominence–Corona Transition Region into Interplanetary Space with Total Solar Eclipse and PSP/WISPR White Light Images*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 998**(1), (2026), p. 51. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ae2ec7>.
- [3] Subash Adhikari, **Riddhi Bandyopadhyay**, Joshua Goodwill, William H. Matthaeus, *et al.*, *Characterization of the Alfvén Transition in the Young Solar Wind using Parker Solar Probe Observations Approaching Solar Maximum*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 997**(2), (2026), p. 259. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ae2c78>.
- [4] M. B. Khan, M. A. Shay, S. Oughton, W. H. Matthaeus, *et al.*, *Factors controlling the statistics of magnetic reconnection in magnetohydrodynamic turbulence*. Phys. Rev. E, **vol. 113**, (2026), p. 015207. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1103/yjh7-hy2s>.
- [5] S. Roy, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, S. Adhikari, Y. Yang, *et al.*, *Energy transfer and conversion in magnetic reconnection: Observation and simulation*. Physics of Plasmas, **vol. 32**(11), (2025), p. 112302. ISSN 1070-664X. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1063/5.0278907>.
- [6] Subash Adhikari, Carlos A. González, Yan Yang, Sean Oughton, *et al.*, *Estimation of Effective Viscosity to Quantify Collisional Behavior in Collisionless Plasma*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 992**(2), (2025), p. 180. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ae08b4>.

*Underlined authors indicate student mentees

- [7] **R. Bandyopadhyay**, J. Ward, D. J. McComas, N. A. Schwadron, *et al.*, *Asymmetric Tangential Velocity inside Switchbacks: Implication for Switchback Origin*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 991**(1), (2025), p. 41. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/adfc45>.
- [8] M. E. Cuesta, G. Livadiotis, D. J. McComas, L. Y. Khoo, *et al.*, *Transfer of Entropy between the Magnetic Field and Solar Energetic Particles during an Interplanetary Coronal Mass Ejection*. The Astrophysical Journal Letters, **vol. 984**(2), (2025), p. L50. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/2041-8213/adcbff>.
- [9] H. A. Farooki, M. E. Cuesta, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, G. Livadiotis, *et al.*, *Estimating the Bulk Velocity of Energetic Particle Populations Using ISOIS/EPI-Lo Measurements*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 984**(1), (2025), p. 70. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/adcl2b>.
- [10] M. Baraka, O. Le Contel, P. Canu, S. W. Alqeeq, *et al.*, *MMS Analysis of a Dayside Compressed Magnetospheric Separatrix in the Presence of Cold Ions and a Moderate Guide Field*. Journal of Geophysical Research: Space Physics, **vol. 130**(4), (2025), p. e2024JA033234. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1029/2024JA033234>.
- [11] M. E. Cuesta, L. Y. Khoo, G. Livadiotis, M. M. Shen, *et al.*, *Comparing Methods for Calculating Solar Energetic Particle Intensities: Rebinning versus Spectral Binning*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 980**(2), (2025), p. 235. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/adaea9>.
- [12] **Riddhi Bandyopadhyay**, James R. Beattie, and Amitava Bhattacharjee, *Density Fluctuation–Mach Number Scaling in Compressible, High Plasma Beta Turbulence: In Situ Space Observations and High-Reynolds Number Simulations*. The Astrophysical Journal Letters, **vol. 982**(2), (2025), p. L45. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/2041-8213/adbe3b>.
- [13] Zachary Bailey, **Riddhi Bandyopadhyay**, Shadia Habbal, and Miloslav Druckmüller, *Measurement of Turbulence Injection Scale Down to the Chromosphere*. The Astrophysical Journal Letters, **vol. 980**(2), (2025), p. L20. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/2041-8213/ada363>.
- [14] J. E. Stawarz, P. A. Muñoz, N. Bessho, R. Bandyopadhyay, *et al.*, *The Interplay Between Collisionless Magnetic Reconnection and Turbulence*. Space Science Reviews, **vol. 220**(8), (2024), p. 90. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/s11214-024-01124-8>.
- [15] David Ruffolo, Panisara Thepthong, Peera Pongkitiwanichakul, Sohom Roy, *et al.*, *Observed Fluctuation Enhancement and Departure from WKB Theory in Sub-Alfvénic Solar Wind*. The Astrophysical Journal Letters, **vol. 977**(1), (2024), p. L19. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/2041-8213/ad9727>.
- [16] O. W. Roberts, K. G. Klein, Z. Vörös, R. Nakamura, *et al.*, *Measurement of the Taylor Microscale and the Effective Magnetic Reynolds Number in the Solar Wind With Cluster*. Journal of Geophysical Research: Space Physics, **vol. 129**(11), (2024), p. e2024JA032968. URL <http://dx.doi.org/https://doi.org/10.1029/2024JA032968>.
- [17] **R. Bandyopadhyay**, N. V. Sarlis, J. M. Weygand, R. J. Strangeway, *et al.*, *Observation of chaotic fluctuations in turbulent plasma*. Physics of Plasmas, **vol. 31**(10), (2024), p. 100702. ISSN 1070-664X. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1063/5.0220376>.
- [18] M. E. Cuesta, A. T. Cummings, G. Livadiotis, D. J. McComas, *et al.*, *Observations of Kappa Distributions in Solar Energetic Protons and Derived Thermodynamic Properties*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 973**(2), (2024), p. 76. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ad68fd>.
- [19] G. Livadiotis, A. T. Cummings, M. E. Cuesta, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, *et al.*, *Kappa-tail Technique: Modeling and Application to Solar Energetic Particles Observed by Parker Solar Probe*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 973**(1), (2024), p. 6. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ad5e72>.
- [20] H. Hasegawa, M. R. Argall, N. Aunai, R. Bandyopadhyay, *et al.*, *Advanced methods for analyzing in-situ observations of magnetic reconnection*. Space Science Reviews, **vol. 220**(1572-9672), (2024), p. 1007/s11214-024-01095-w. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/s11214-024-01095-w>.
- [21] J. T. Lang, R. D. Strauss, N. E. Engelbrecht, J. P. van den Berg, *et al.*, *A Detailed Survey of the Parallel Mean Free Path of Solar Energetic Particle Protons and Electrons*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 971**(1), (2024), p. 105. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ad55c3>.

- [22] Manuel Enrique Cuesta, D. J. McComas, L. Y. Khoo, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, *et al.*, *Correlation of Coronal Mass Ejection Shock Temperature with Solar Energetic Particle Intensity*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 964**(2), (2024), p. 114. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ad245d>.
- [23] S. Roy, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, W. H. Matthaeus, and P. S. Pyakurel, *Energy Dissipation in Electron-only Reconnection*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 964**(1), (2024), p. 44. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ad2769>.
- [24] C. A. González, J. L. Verniero, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, and A. Tenerani, *Local Proton Heating at Magnetic Discontinuities in Alfvénic and Non-Alfvénic Solar Wind*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 963**(2), (2024), p. 148. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ad1be5>.
- [25] Yan Yang, William H Matthaeus, Sean Oughton, **Riddhi Bandyopadhyay**, *et al.*, *Effective viscosity, resistivity, and Reynolds number in weakly collisional plasma turbulence*. Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, **vol. 528**(4), (2024), pp. 6119. ISSN 0035-8711. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1093/mnras/stae355>.
- [26] Panisara Thepthong, Peera Pongkitiwanichakul, David Ruffolo, Rungployphan Kieokaew, *et al.*, *Scale and Time Dependence of Alfvénicity in the Solar Wind as Observed by the Parker Solar Probe*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 962**(1), (2024), p. 37. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ad1592>.
- [27] **R. Bandyopadhyay**, C. M. Meyer, C. M. Meyer, Bailey C. M. Meyer, W. H. Matthaeus, D. J. McComas, *et al.*, *Estimates of Proton and Electron Heating Rates Extended to the Near-Sun Environment*. The Astrophysical Journal Letters, **vol. 955**(2), (2023), p. L28. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/2041-8213/acf85e>.
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- [29] **Riddhi Bandyopadhyay**, Yan Yang, William H. Matthaeus, Tulasi N. Parashar, *et al.*, *Collisional-like dissipation in collisionless plasmas*. Physics of Plasmas, **vol. 30**(8), (2023), p. 080702. ISSN 1070-664X. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1063/5.0146986>.
- [30] F Pecora, Y Yang, A Chasapis, S Servidio, *et al.*, *Relaxation of the turbulent magnetosheath*. Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, **vol. 525**(1), (2023), pp. 67. ISSN 0035-8711. <https://academic.oup.com/mnras/article-pdf/525/1/67/51088731/stad2232.pdf>, URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1093/mnras/stad2232>.
- [31] J. L. Burch, K. J. Genestreti, S. V. Heuer, A. Chasapis, *et al.*, *Electron energy dissipation in a magnetotail reconnection region*. Physics of Plasmas, **vol. 30**(8), (2023), p. 082903. ISSN 1070-664X. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1063/5.0153628>.
- [32] Maruca, Bennett A., Qudsi, Ramiz A., Alterman, B. L., Walsh, Brian M., *et al.*, *The Trans-Heliospheric Survey - Radial trends in plasma parameters across the heliosphere*. Astronomy & Astrophysics, **vol. 675**, (2023), p. A196. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1051/0004-6361/202345951>.
- [33] N. Andrés, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, D. J. McComas, J. R. Szalay, *et al.*, *Observation of Turbulent Magnetohydrodynamic Cascade in the Jovian Magnetosheath*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 945**(1), (2023), p. 8. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/acb7e0>.
- [34] Yan Yang, Francesco Pecora, William H. Matthaeus, Sohom Roy, *et al.*, *Quantifying the Agyrotropy of Proton and Electron Heating in Turbulent Plasmas*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 944**(2), (2023), p. 148. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/acb25a>.
- [35] N. E. Raouafi, L. Matteini, J. Squire, S. T. Badman, *et al.*, *Parker Solar Probe: Four Years of Discoveries at Solar Cycle Minimum*. Space Science Reviews, **vol. 219**(1572-9672), (2023), p. 8. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/s11214-023-00952-4>.
- [36] S. Roy, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, Y. Yang, T. N. Parashar, *et al.*, *Turbulent Energy Transfer and Proton–Electron Heating in Collisionless Plasmas*. The Astrophysical Journal, **vol. 941**(2), (2022), p. 137. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/aca479>.
- [37] C. Phillips, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, D. J. McComas, and S. D. Bale, *Association of intermittency with electron heating in the near-Sun solar wind*. Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society: Letters. ISSN 1745-3925. Slac143, URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1093/mnrasl/slac143>.

- [38] **Riddhi Bandyopadhyay**, Ramiz A. Qudsi, S. Peter Gary, William H. Matthaeus, *et al.*, *Interplay of turbulence and proton-microinstability growth in space plasmas*. *Physics of Plasmas*, **vol. 29**(10), (2022), p. 102107. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1063/5.0098625>.
- [39] Yanwen Wang, Rohit Chhiber, Subash Adhikari, Yan Yang, *et al.*, *Strategies for Determining the Cascade Rate in MHD Turbulence: Isotropy, Anisotropy, and Spacecraft Sampling*. *The Astrophysical Journal*, **vol. 937**(2), (2022), p. 76. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ac8f90>.
- [40] J. Zhang, S. Y. Huang, Z. G. Yuan, K. Jiang, *et al.*, *Higher-order Turbulence Statistics in the Sub-Alfvénic Solar Wind Observed by Parker Solar Probe*. *The Astrophysical Journal*, **vol. 937**(2), (2022), p. 70. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ac8c34>.
- [41] **R. Bandyopadhyay**, L. J. Begley, B. A. Maruca, D. J. McComas, *et al.*, *Beta-Dependent Constraints on Ion Temperature Anisotropy in Jupiter's Magnetosheath*. *Geophysical Research Letters*, **vol. 49**(15), (2022), p. e2022GL098053. URL <http://dx.doi.org/https://doi.org/10.1029/2022GL098053>.
- [42] C. Phillips, **R. Bandyopadhyay**, and D. J. McComas, *Taylor microscale and effective Reynolds number near the Sun from PSP*. *The Astrophysical Journal*, **vol. 933**(1), (2022), p. 33. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/1538-4357/ac713f>.
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- [44] Manuel Enrique Cuesta, Rohit Chhiber, Sohom Roy, Joshua Goodwill, *et al.*, *Isotropization and Evolution of Energy-containing Eddies in Solar Wind Turbulence: Parker Solar Probe, Helios 1, ACE, WIND, and Voyager 1*. *The Astrophysical Journal Letters*, **vol. 932**(1), (2022), p. L11. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3847/2041-8213/ac73fd>.
- [45] Sakshee Sakshee, **Riddhi Bandyopadhyay**, and Supratik Banerjee, *MHD-scale anisotropy in solar wind turbulence near the Sun using Parker solar probe data*. *Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society*, **vol. 514**(1), (2022), pp. 1282. ISSN 0035-8711. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1093/mnras/stac1449>.
- [46] Rohit Chhiber, William H Matthaeus, Arcadi V Usmanov, **Riddhi Bandyopadhyay**, *et al.*, *An extended and fragmented Alfvén zone in the Young Solar Wind*. *Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society*, **vol. 513**(1), (2022), pp. 159. ISSN 0035-8711. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1093/mnras/stac779>.
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- [54] **R. Bandyopadhyay**, D. J. McComas, J. R. Szalay, F. Allegrini, *et al.*, *Observation of Kolmogorov Turbulence in the Jovian Magnetosheath From JADE Data*. Geophysical Research Letters, **vol. 48**(15), (2021), p. e2021GL095006. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1029/2021GL095006>.
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor (University of Delaware)

PHYS635 Space Physics (Graduate level course on physical processes in our solar system) Spring 2026

Guest Lecturer (University of Delaware)

Plasma Physics I (Graduate level course on fluids and magnetohydrodynamics) Fall 2019

PHYS638 Turbulent Flows (Graduate level course on fundamental characteristics of turbulence) Spring 2025

PHYS809 Electrodynamics I (Graduate level course on Electrodynamics) Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant (University of Delaware)

Introductory Physics I (Introduction to classical physics and fluid mechanics for students in the life and environmental sciences) 2017 Winter, 2017 Fall, 2018 Winter

Introductory Physics II (Introduction to electromagnetism and optics for students in the life and environmental sciences) 2017 Spring

Fundamentals of Physics II (Introduction to electromagnetism for students in the physical sciences and engineering) 2017 Summer, 2017 Fall

SYNERGISTIC ACTIVITIES

Reviewer for The Astrophysical Journal (ApJ), The Astrophysical Journal Letters (ApJL), Journal of Geophysical Research: Space Physics (JGR), Geophysical Research Letters (GRL), Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society (MNRAS), Physics of Plasmas (PoP), Physical Review Letters (PRL), Earth and Space Science (ESS), Physical Review E (PRE), Scientific Reports, Astronomy & Astrophysics (A & A), Nature Communications, Journal of Plasma Physics (JPP), Space Science Reviews (SSR) (~ 10 per year).

Review Panels

NASA Review Panelist 2021, 2022, 2023

NSF Review Panelist 2025

National Research and Development Agency, Government of Chile 2022, 2024, 2025

NASA External Reviewer 2020, 2024, 2026

NASA Executive Secretary 2020

Conference Panel Organization

Magnetospheric Multiscale (MMS) Mission Science Working Team meeting Spring 2020, Fall 2020, Fall 2024

Interstellar Boundary Explorer (IBEX) Mission Science Team meeting 2021, 2022

Solar Heliospheric and Interplanetary Environment (SHINE) workshop 2022, 2023, 2024

Graduate Student & Dissertation Advising

Next Position

William Taranto (Ph.D. expected 2030, University of Delaware) N/A (ongoing)

Sohom Roy (Ph.D. December 2024, University of Delaware) postdoc at Space Research Institute (Institut für Weltraumforschung, IWF), Graz, Austria

Camryn Phillips (Fall 2021 and Spring 2022 semester projects, Princeton University) changed field

Undergraduate Student Advising

Next Position

Yanwen Wang, '22 (2019 Sophomore Project), University of Delaware Ph.D. student at the University of Maryland, College Park

Luke Begley, '22 (2020 Junior Project), Princeton University joined industry

Siegfried Gawenda, '23 (2022 Spring Junior Project), Princeton University Ph.D. student at the University of Texas Rio Grande Valley

Ryan LoRusso, '24 (2022 Fall Junior Project), Princeton University	Ph.D. student at Indiana University at Bloomington
Cole Meyer, '24 (2022 Fall Junior Project), Princeton University	Ph.D. student at Lunar and Planetary Laboratory at the University of Arizona
Juston Ward, '24 (Princeton University Undergraduate Summer Research Program via National Radio Astronomy Observatory/National Astronomy Consortium; 2023&2024 Summer), Sam Houston State University	Ph.D. student at Baylor University
Alex Bruce, '26 (2025 Winter Project), University of Delaware	–

Thesis Committee

External member for dissertation proposal of Zac Bailey at the Institute for Astronomy, University of Hawai'i (2026)

Research Readiness Exam Committee Chair for Zihang Cheng (advisor: Prof. Yan Yang), University of Dealawre (2026)

Public Outreach

Lecture and public interaction at the “[Science Under the Stars](#)” series organized by the New Jersey State Museum.

Miscellaneous

Invited member of the Solar Heliospheric and INterplanetary Environment (SHINE) workshop Steering Committee.